Music Recommendations by Situation

Recommended music for studying, working, exercising, relaxing, travelling, parties and rainy days, plus the Spotify AI Assistant project's own curated playlists.

1. How these recommendations work

Music affects concentration, energy and mood differently depending on the activity. This guide gives, for each situation, the recommended characteristics (tempo, energy, lyrics), suggested genres and a selection of real songs. The Energy Scale (1–5) used here is the one defined in the *Music Genres Guide*.

> **Important:** the playlists in this document are concepts curated by the Spotify AI Assistant project team. They are **not** official Spotify playlists and they do not exist automatically in any Spotify account. The assistant may suggest them, but it must not claim to have created them in Spotify.

General rules used by the assistant

- **Lyrics vs. instrumental:** for tasks with a lot of reading or writing, instrumental music is recommended, because lyrics compete for verbal attention.
- **Energy matching:** calm tasks → Energy 1–2; routine or physical tasks → Energy 3–5.
- **Familiarity:** for concentration, familiar music is usually less distracting than new music. For discovery sessions, use the 70/30 rule from the *Artist Discovery Guide*.
- **Duration:** a song lasts about 3–4 minutes on average, so one hour is roughly 15–18 songs.

2. Studying and deep focus

Characteristics: Energy 1–2, mostly instrumental, stable tempo, no sudden changes.

Genres: Neoclassical piano, ambient, downtempo electronic, cool jazz, lo-fi hip-hop.

Song	Artist	Genre
Nuvole Bianche	Ludovico Einaudi	Neoclassical
On the Nature of Daylight	Max Richter	Neoclassical
Says	Nils Frahm	Ambient / electronic
An Ending (Ascent)	Brian Eno	Ambient
Gymnopédie No. 1	Erik Satie	Classical
Clair de lune	Claude Debussy	Classical
Awake	Tycho	Downtempo electronic
Kerala	Bonobo	Downtempo electronic
Blue in Green	Miles Davis	Cool jazz
Peace Piece	Bill Evans	Jazz piano

3. Working and coding

Characteristics: Energy 2–3, mostly instrumental with some light vocals, a steady groove that keeps momentum without being distracting.

Song	Artist	Genre
Open Eye Signal	Jon Hopkins	Electronic
Your Hand in Mine	Explosions in the Sky	Post-rock
Time	Hans Zimmer	Film score
Avril 14th	Aphex Twin	Ambient piano
August 10	Khruangbin	Psychedelic instrumental
Cirrus	Bonobo	Downtempo electronic

4. Workout and gym

Characteristics: Energy 4–5, about 120–150 BPM for cardio, strong beats and motivating lyrics.

Genres: Hip-hop, EDM, rock anthems, pop with strong beats.

Song	Artist	Genre
Lose Yourself	Eminem	Hip-hop
Till I Collapse	Eminem	Hip-hop
HUMBLE.	Kendrick Lamar	Hip-hop
Stronger	Kanye West	Hip-hop / electronic
Can't Hold Us	Macklemore & Ryan Lewis	Hip-hop
Titanium	David Guetta feat. Sia	EDM
Levels	Avicii	EDM
Blinding Lights	The Weeknd	Synth-pop
Eye of the Tiger	Survivor	Rock
Seven Nation Army	The White Stripes	Garage rock

5. Relaxing and evenings

Characteristics: Energy 1–2, warm and soft sounds, slow tempo.

Song	Artist	Genre
Dreams	Fleetwood Mac	Soft rock
Redbone	Childish Gambino	Funk / R&B
Pink + White	Frank Ocean	Alternative R&B
Holocene	Bon Iver	Indie folk
Banana Pancakes	Jack Johnson	Acoustic
Cherry Wine	Hozier	Folk

Song	Artist	Genre
Sunset Lover	Petit Biscuit	Chill electronic
Here Comes the Sun	The Beatles	Pop rock

6. Road trips and travelling

Characteristics: Energy 3–4, sing-along choruses, feelings of freedom and movement.

Song	Artist	Genre
Go Your Own Way	Fleetwood Mac	Rock
Mr. Blue Sky	Electric Light Orchestra	Rock / pop
Africa	Toto	Soft rock
Don't Stop Me Now	Queen	Rock
Don't Stop Believin'	Journey	Rock
The Less I Know the Better	Tame Impala	Psychedelic pop
Electric Feel	MGMT	Psychedelic pop
Mr. Brightside	The Killers	Alternative rock

7. Parties

Characteristics: Energy 5, danceable, well-known hits mixed with current songs. Reggaeton usually sits at about 90–100 BPM and house at about 120–128 BPM.

Song	Artist	Genre
Get Lucky	Daft Punk feat. Pharrell Williams	Disco / electronic
One More Time	Daft Punk	French house
Levitating	Dua Lipa	Dance-pop
Don't Start Now	Dua Lipa	Dance-pop
Uptown Funk	Mark Ronson feat. Bruno Mars	Funk-pop
Gasolina	Daddy Yankee	Reggaeton
Tití Me Preguntó	Bad Bunny	Reggaeton / dembow
Despechá	Rosalía	Mambo / Latin pop
Pepas	Farruko	Latin EDM

8. Rainy days and melancholic moments

Characteristics: Energy 1–3, emotional lyrics, acoustic or atmospheric sound.

Song	Artist	Genre
Fix You	Coldplay	Alternative rock
Skinny Love	Bon Iver	Indie folk
The Night We Met	Lord Huron	Indie folk

Song	Artist	Genre
Motion Sickness	Phoebe Bridgers	Indie rock
Liability	Lorde	Pop ballad
Exit Music (For a Film)	Radiohead	Alternative rock
505	Arctic Monkeys	Indie rock

9. Curated playlists of the Spotify AI Assistant project

Tecnun Study Session (2 hours)

A study playlist designed by the project team for a two-hour session. It follows a three-block structure so that the student's energy stays stable:

- **Block 1 – "Warm-up focus" (first 45 minutes, Energy 1):** neoclassical piano and ambient. Example songs: "Nuvole Bianche" (Ludovico Einaudi), "On the Nature of Daylight" (Max Richter), "Says" (Nils Frahm), "An Ending (Ascent)" (Brian Eno).
- **Block 2 – "Deep work" (next 45 minutes, Energy 2):** instrumental downtempo electronic. Example songs: "Awake" (Tycho), "Kerala" (Bonobo), "Open Eye Signal" (Jon Hopkins), "Cirrus" (Bonobo).
- **Block 3 – "Final push" (last 30 minutes, Energy 2):** cool jazz. Example songs: "So What" and "Blue in Green" (Miles Davis), "Take Five" (The Dave Brubeck Quartet), "Peace Piece" (Bill Evans).

Recommended break: a 5-minute pause with no music between Block 2 and Block 3.

Gym Power Hour (60 minutes)

- **Warm-up (10 min, Energy 3):** "Mr. Brightside", "Seven Nation Army".
- **Main workout (40 min, Energy 5):** "Till I Collapse", "HUMBLE.", "Stronger", "Can't Hold Us", "Titanium", "Levels".
- **Cool-down (10 min, Energy 2):** "Redbone", "Sunset Lover".

10. Quick decision table

If the user wants to...	Energy	Lyrics?	Start with
Study or read	1–2	No	Tecnun Study Session
Code or work	2–3	Few	Section 3
Exercise	4–5	Yes	Gym Power Hour
Relax	1–2	Optional	Section 5
Travel by car	3–4	Yes, sing-along	Section 6
Party	5	Yes	Section 7
Process emotions	1–3	Yes	Section 8